

INDUSTRY BENCHMARK REPORT – TELECOM CONTACT CENTERS INDIA

Q4 FY26 | Published by SQM Group in partnership with Deloitte India
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Executive Summary

Top-performing telecom contact centers in India continue to pull ahead of the median. Key highlights from Q4 FY26:

- **Top Quartile Service Level:** 88% (vs Median 82%)
- **Top Quartile Average Handle Time:** 5.5 minutes (vs Median 6.1 min)
- **Top Quartile First Call Resolution:** 82% (vs Median 76%)
- **Top Quartile Cost per Call:** ₹32 (vs Median ₹38)
- **Top Quartile NPS:** 82 (vs Median 75)

Key Trends Observed in 2025–26

1. AI and automation adoption has accelerated significantly among top performers
2. Self-service deflection rates above 45% are now common among leaders
3. Shrinkage control below 28% is a consistent characteristic of top-quartile performers
4. Multi-channel integration (voice + chat + WhatsApp) is becoming table stakes

Detailed Benchmark Table – Telecom Sector (India)

Metric	Bottom Quartile	Median	Top Quartile	Quick Telecom Current
Service Level (20 sec)	72%	82%	88%	78%
Average Handle Time (min)	8.2	6.1	5.5	6.8

Metric	Bottom Quartile	Median	Top Quartile	Quick Telecom Current
First Call Resolution	62%	76%	82%	71%
Cost per Call (₹)	58	38	32	48
NPS	62	75	82	71%
Agent Utilization	68%	76%	82%	76%
Shrinkage	38%	31%	26%	29%
Self-Service Deflection Rate	22%	35%	48%	34%

Top Performer Profiles

Airtel Xperience Center

Service Level	89%
AHT	5.3 min
FCR	84%
Cost per Call	₹29
NPS	84

Key Enablers: Advanced AI routing, 52% self-service deflection, 24% shrinkage

JioCare Excellence Hubs

Service Level	87%
AHT	5.6 min
FCR	81%
Cost per Call	₹31
NPS	81

Key Enablers: Strong knowledge base, proactive outbound, 47% self-service

Vodafone Idea SmartCare

Service Level	86%
AHT	5.7 min
FCR	80%
Cost per Call	₹33
NPS	80

Key Enablers: WhatsApp-first strategy, 41% self-service, excellent coaching culture

Recommendations for Quick Telecom

1. Accelerate AI-powered call routing implementation
2. Invest in knowledge base quality and agent enablement
3. Reduce shrinkage through better scheduling and self-service
4. Launch proactive communication programs to reduce inbound volume
5. Focus on First Call Resolution as a key lever for both cost and NPS

Appendix A – Competitor Deep Dive

Airtel Xperience Center Transformation Journey (2023–2025)

Airtel invested ₹240 Cr over 24 months in AI routing, knowledge base, and agent enablement.

Key initiatives included:

- Launch of “Airtel Assistant” – AI chatbot handling 52% of queries
- Complete overhaul of knowledge base with 18,000+ articles
- Real-time coaching tool “CoachAI” deployed to all 4,200 agents
- WhatsApp Business integration for billing and recharge queries

Transformation Results

Metric	Before	After
Service Level	74%	89%

Metric	Before	After
AHT	7.8 min	5.3 min
FCR	64%	84%
Cost per call	₹54	₹29
NPS	61	84

JioCare Excellence Hubs – Case Study

Jio focused on proactive outbound communication and self-service. Major initiatives:

- “JioCare Pro” app with 67% self-service adoption
- Proactive SMS/APP notifications for bill due, data usage, and plan expiry
- Centralized knowledge base with voice-enabled search
- Gamification platform “JioStars” for agent motivation

Case Study Results

Metric	Value
Queries handled via self-service	47%
Inbound call volume reduction	31%
AHT	5.6 minutes
NPS	81

Vodafone Idea SmartCare Program

Vodafone Idea adopted a “WhatsApp-first” strategy combined with strong coaching culture. Key initiatives:

- WhatsApp Business API handling 41% of customer interactions
- “SmartCoach” real-time guidance tool for agents
- Monthly quality calibration across all 9 sites
- Agent well-being program reducing attrition to 11%

Program Results

Metric	Value
Service Level	86%
FCR	80%

Metric	Value
Cost per call	₹33
NPS	80

Appendix B – ESG & Sustainability in Contact Centers

Paperless Operations Initiative

Leading contact centers have achieved 67–78% paperless operations through:

- Digital onboarding and KYC
- E-billing and e-receipts
- Digital complaint logging and resolution
- Paperless quality calibration sessions

Carbon-Neutral Contact Centers

Top performers have achieved carbon-neutral operations through:

- 100% renewable energy for contact center facilities
- EV fleet for field technicians (42–58% of total fleet)
- Carbon offset programs for air travel and logistics

Plastic Reduction Programs

Major initiatives include:

- Elimination of single-use plastic bottles and cups
- Biodegradable headsets and accessories
- Digital training materials instead of printed manuals

Quick Telecom ESG Progress (2025)

ESG Progress Area	Metric	Value	Target/Note
Paperless Interactions	Percentage of total	67%	75% by March 2027
Carbon-Neutral Ops	Tier 1 Cities	Achieved	Mumbai, Delhi, and Bangalore
EV Fleet Expansion	Vehicle count / % of field fleet	340 / 28%	Ongoing expansion

ESG Progress Area	Metric	Value	Target/Note
Plastic Reduction	Single-use items avoided	1.8 million	Avoided in 2025

Appendix C – Technology & Digital Trends 2026

Technology Trends Benchmarks

Technology Trend	Adoption Rate	Key Performance Metric	Performance Value
AI Chatbot Adoption	78%	Containment Rate (Top performers)	52–61%
WhatsApp Integration	67%	Response time (< 2 min)	89% of messages
Voice Biometrics	42%	Authentication time reduction	45s to 8s
Generative AI Pilots	23%	Improvement in FCR	18–24%

AI Chatbot Adoption

- 78% of telecom contact centers now have AI chatbots
- Average containment rate: 34–52%
- Top performers achieving 52–61% containment

WhatsApp Business Integration

- 67% of telecom companies now offer WhatsApp support
- Average 28–41% of queries handled via WhatsApp
- Response time under 2 minutes for 89% of messages

Voice Biometrics & Authentication

- 42% of contact centers have deployed voice biometrics
- Average authentication time reduced from 45 seconds to 8 seconds
- Fraud reduction of 67% reported by early adopters

Generative AI Pilots

- 23% of contact centers running generative AI pilots for knowledge suggestions
- Early results show 18–24% improvement in First Call Resolution
- Agent satisfaction scores improved by 12–15 points

CRM & Technology Upgrades

- 89% of contact centers upgraded CRM in last 24 months
- Salesforce and Genesys remain most popular platforms
- Average ROI on CRM upgrade: 2.8 years

Appendix D – Regional Performance Variations

Zone	Avg. Service Level	Avg. AHT	Avg. FCR	Key Insight
North	79%	6.9 min	69%	Highest call volume during festive seasons (Diwali, Eid)
West	81%	6.5 min	73%	Strongest performance in self-service adoption (39%)
South	80%	6.4 min	74%	Best-in-class coaching culture and lowest attrition (12%)
East	74%	7.4 min	65%	Highest shrinkage (34%) and lowest self-service adoption (24%)

Appendix E – Methodology & Data Sources

Data Collection Period
Q3–Q4 FY26 (July–December 2025)

- Sample Size
- 47 contact centers across 12 telecom companies
 - 18,400+ agents
 - 42 million+ customer interactions analyzed

- Data Sources
- Operational data from participating companies (anonymized)
 - Customer surveys (minimum 15% response rate)
 - Agent surveys and focus groups
 - Technology platform data (CRM, ACD, Quality systems)

Statistical Methodology

- All metrics calculated using weighted averages
- Outliers removed using 3-standard deviation rule
- Confidence level: 95%
- Margin of error: $\pm 2.1\%$

Limitations

- Self-reported data from participating companies
- Different definitions of “Top Quartile” across sources
- Limited visibility into BPO partner performance
- Seasonal variations may affect certain metrics